ENG529 (SHORT NOTES)

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CHAPTER 8

1. What is blended learning?

Blended learning is an educational approach that combines face-to-face (synchronous) and online (asynchronous) learning environments in a complementary manner to support a program of study.

2. How does blended learning differ from traditional teaching methods?

Blended learning integrates various learning environments, combining traditional classroom settings with online activities to create a flexible and learner-centered approach.

3. According to Picciano (2009), what defines blended classes?

Blended classes, according to Picciano (2009), involve the integration of face-to-face and online activities in a planned, pedagogically valuable manner, where online activities replace a portion of face-to-face time.

4. What are the main considerations before adopting a blended approach?

Before adopting a blended approach, consider factors such as

- Teacher training
- Choosing an appropriate blend
- Costs
- Attrition and motivation
- Importance of peer support.

5. How does blended learning benefit language learners?

Blended learning benefits language learners by

- Providing a flexible and time-effective way to incorporate online mediums
- Enhancing communicative competence
- Addressing the limited time available for traditional classroom listening activities.

6. What role does technology play in blended learning?[1]

Technology in blended learning facilitates

- Learner-learner interaction,
- Supports incidental learning
- Allows learners and teachers to stay connected outside the classroom
- It enables a rich, supportive, and learner-centered learning environment

7. How can teachers maximize the benefits of blended learning in the classroom?

Teachers can maximize benefits by

- Focusing on output in the classroom,
- Using the online environment for preparation and practice
- Ensuring the blend is adapted to learners' needs, making the learning process more effective.

8. What is the significance of peer support in blended learning?

Peer support in blended learning helps fill knowledge gaps, encourages idea sharing, develops communication and social skills, motivates learners, and eases the teacher's workload by facilitating prompt responses to individual queries.

9. How can blended learning be cost-effective?

Blended learning can be cost-effective by shifting the focus from providing more effective teaching to producing more effective student learning, utilizing resources efficiently, and achieving learning objectives in a cost-efficient manner.

10. Why is a cultural shift from teaching to learning important in blended courses?

A cultural shift encourages students to take more responsibility for their learning, fostering motivation and self-discipline. It aligns with the discovery and self-directed learning approach encouraged in blended courses.

CHAPTER 9

11. What is the goal of integrating technology into the curriculum?

The goal is to guide, expand, and enhance learning objectives, providing new opportunities for students and making technology an integral part of the classroom.

12. What is curriculum design, and why is it important?

Curriculum design is the systematic organization of curriculum within a class or course, identifying what will be done, who will do it, and the schedule to follow. It ensures alignment and complementarity of learning goals across different stages.

13. How should teachers approach the integration of technology into their teaching?

Teachers should strive to become computer-using teachers and view technology as a teaching partner rather than an object of study. Familiarity with using computers, not understanding their inner workings, is essential for effective integration.

14. What role does technology play in student engagement?

Technology in the classroom makes subjects more interesting and provides opportunities for fun and enjoyable learning. It allows for gamification, virtual field trips, and various online resources to engage students actively.

15. How does technology contribute to better knowledge retention?

Engaged and interested students, facilitated by technology, tend to have improved knowledge retention. Technology encourages active participation, a crucial factor in retaining knowledge.

16. What is a significant advantage of technology in catering to different learning styles?

Technology allows for individualized learning experiences. Students can learn at their own pace, review difficult concepts, and have access to resources tailored to their specific needs.

17. How does technology promote collaboration among students?

Technology facilitates collaboration through online activities, projects, and document sharing. It enables students to work together not only within the same classroom but also with peers globally.

18. Besides academic knowledge, what practical skills can students develop through technology?

Technology in the classroom helps students acquire essential 21st-century skills, such as collaboration, critical thinking, effective communication, and proficiency in using digital tools.

19. How can technology benefit teachers in terms of time management?

Technology helps teachers save time with virtual lesson plans, grading software, and online assessments. It enhances collaboration among educators, allowing them to share resources and streamline administrative tasks.

20. Name three examples of effective technologies for a successful curriculum.

Digital books, classroom clickers (student response systems), and interactive whiteboards are effective technologies that enhance the curriculum and promote interactive learning.

These benefits highlight the positive impact of technology on both student learning experiences and teaching practices in the modern classroom.

21. Why is collaboration encouraged through technology in the classroom?

Technology allows students to collaborate on projects, share documents, and engage with peers locally and globally. This encourages teamwork and enhances collaboration skills.

22. How does technology benefit teachers in terms of time management?

Technology, such as virtual lesson plans, grading software, and online assessments, helps teachers save time. It allows them to focus on students who need additional support and promotes collaboration among educators.

23. What are some benefits of using digital books in the curriculum?

Digital books are portable, convenient, and make learning resources easily accessible. They contribute to a paperless environment, making it easier for both teachers and students.

24. How do interactive whiteboards enhance learning in the classroom?

Interactive whiteboards make lessons interactive, allowing students to interact with learning material through touch, drawing, or writing. They facilitate creative lessons, immediate feedback, and engagement, contributing to increased comprehension and literacy.

25. What outcomes can be expected from integrating technology into the curriculum?

The outcomes include more engaged students, simplified materials, increased motivation, better-developed collaboration skills, and overall increased student achievement due to personalized and interactive learning experiences.

26. Why is integrating technology into the curriculum important for the future?

It is necessary to prepare teachers and students for the digital future, equipping them with essential 21st-century skills. Technology integration ensures success in a digital economy and helps students develop practical skills for their future endeavors.

CHAPTER 10

27. What is e-assessment?

E-assessment, or electronic assessment, involves using information technology for various forms of assessment, such as educational, health, psychiatric, and psychological assessments.

28. What are the practical challenges in transitioning to fully electronic assessments?

Practical challenges include the need for adequate IT hardware, ensuring security during electronic exams, and resolving logistical issues for large-scale assessments.

29. What are some types of e-assessment?

Types include multiple-choice tests, online/electronic submission, peer assessment, and various forms of assessments serving formative, diagnostic, or summative purposes.

30. What is e-marking?

E-marking involves utilizing technology, such as electronic annotations or online feedback, for expediting the marking of examinations.

31. What are the advantages of e-assessment?

Advantages include immediate feedback, accessibility for students in different locations and times, sophisticated reporting, and the ability for students to assess and re-assess their knowledge.

32. What is self-assessment in the context of e-assessment?

Self-assessment involves learners critically reflecting on and recording the progress of their learning, contributing to the development of autonomous learners.

33. Why is peer assessment used in e-assessment?

Peer assessment encourages constructive criticism, helps students learn from each other, promotes engagement with marking criteria, and provides more efficient and timely feedback for large groups.

34. What is a student response system (SRS) in e-assessment?

A student response system is technology used in face-to-face teaching to facilitate interactivity, enhance feedback processes, and collect data from students.

35. How does e-assessment contribute to immediate feedback for students?

E-assessment allows for immediate feedback tailored to help students improve their knowledge and performance.

36. What are some approaches for providing feedback in e-assessment?

Approaches include providing digital feedback files, annotatin work, using online feedback forms (rubrics), creating audio or video feedback, and annotating work directly in e-assessment platforms like Blackboard or Turnitin.

37. What are the reasons for using e-assessment?

- Answer: Reasons for using e-assessment include immediate feedback to aid student improvement, accessibility for students in different locations and times, sophisticated reporting for refining exercises, and allowing students to assess and re-assess their knowledge.

CHAPTER 11

38. Why is online reading considered different from traditional reading?

Online reading allows for interactive engagement with text and others, but it also exposes readers to distractions and information overload.

39. What challenges do L2 learners face in online reading?

L2 learners may struggle with linguistic limitations and processing challenges, requiring support to overcome these obstacles in online reading.

40. How are reading theories categorized for both L1 and L2?**

Reading theories are categorized into structural (bottom-up), cognitive (top-down), and metacognitive perspectives.

41. What does the cognitive view emphasize in reading?

The cognitive view emphasizes the role of background knowledge, interactive nature, and constructive aspects of comprehension in reading.

42. How does the passage describe Speech Recognition (SR) technology in L2 learning?

Speech Recognition (SR) technology interprets the meaning of a speaker's utterances, and it has been increasingly incorporated in L2 learning to enhance reading abilities.

43. What are some challenges faced by educators in the technological age of reading?

Educators face challenges in leading distracted readers back to productive learning and keeping up with evolving technologies to design effective instruction.

44. What are the three trends in technology of learning for L2 reading?

The trends include ubiquitous learning, adaptive learning, and personalization, along with working toward autonomous learning.

45. What are some categories of technologies relevant to L2 reading ?

The categories include

- Self-developed and commercial courseware
- Online activities with individual tools and mobile devices
- Computer-Mediated Communication (CMC) technologies.

46. How is self-developed courseware typically designed for L2 reading?

Self-developed courseware is designed collaboratively to create language learning tools tailored to specific learner groups, often incorporating various stages and components available online.

47. What is the role of intelligent tutoring systems (ITS) in self-developed courseware for L2 reading?

Intelligent tutoring systems (ITS) are increasingly incorporated into self-developed courseware to provide immediate, customized instruction and feedback to learners, simulating a human tutor's behavior.

48. What is the distinction between online activities and courseware in L2 reading, according to Stockwell (2007)?

Online activities refer to smaller-scale independent activities that are not part of a larger package, differing from comprehensive courseware.

49. How do dictionaries, glosses, and annotations contribute to L2 vocabulary learning in online activities?

Electronic dictionaries, glosses, and annotations support L2 vocabulary learning by providing word definitions, spellings, pronunciations, example sentences, and linguistic resources.

50. What role do concordancing tools play in L2 reading?

Concordancing tools are corpus analysis tools that extract instances of a given word from a corpus, aiding learners by presenting occurrences and contexts, contributing to L2 reading comprehension.

51. How are mobile devices utilized for L2 learning, particularly in the context of reading?

Mobile devices, such as smartphones and tablets, offer advantages in portability and access to information, supporting L2 reading through various apps and tools designed for language learning.

52. What role do Computer-Mediated Communication (CMC) technologies play in L2 reading instruction?

CMC technologies, including chat, Moo, and email, facilitate cooperative reading and co-construction of meaning among learners of different linguistic backgrounds, integrating sociocultural and learner-centered perspectives into reading instruction.

CHAPTER 12

53. How are lower-grade students encouraged to go beyond traditional writing tasks?

Lower-grade students may be asked to go beyond traditional writing tasks by creating PowerPoint slides, collages, or contributing text to blogs in addition to writing sentences.

54. What role do Web 2.0 applications play in L2 learning?

Web 2.0 applications, such as social media sites and blogs, provide opportunities for L2 learners to experiment with language in real settings, engage with real audiences, and participate in collaborative writing.

55. Provide an example of a Web 2.0 application mentioned in the chapter.

Lang-8 (http://lang-8.com/) is cited as a social networking site designed to encourage L2 communication. It matches language learners with native speakers for collaborative language learning.

56. How does Google Docs differ from traditional word processing software?

Google Docs, unlike traditional word processing software, allows for real-time collaboration, including editing, commenting, and chatting among multiple users on a shared file. It also automatically saves the revision history.

57. Name a widely used Automated Writing Evaluation (AWE) system.

Criterion (http://www.ets.org/criterion/) is mentioned as a web-based commercial writing evaluation and feedback tool developed by Educational Testing Service (ETS).

58. What is the Corpus of Contemporary American English (COCA), and what is its purpose?

COCA (http://corpus.byu.edu/coca/) is a freely available online corpus of English with over 450 million words of text. It serves as a resource for L2 writers to access examples of authentic language use in various genres.

59. What is learning analytics, and how can it benefit L2 writing?

Learning analytics involves collecting, measuring, and analyzing students' learning data to understand learning processes and predict outcomes. In L2 writing, tools like Mi-Writer are mentioned, which capture data throughout the writing process and provide real-time feedback.

60. What are the three general categories of technologies for L2 writing.

The three general categories are Web 2.0 Applications, Automated Writing Evaluation (AWE) systems, and Corpus-Based Tools.

CHAPTER 13

61. Define affordances in the context of technology tools and applications.

Affordances refer to the perceived possibilities that users have for utilizing technology tools and applications, shaped by theory and practice in the context of second language learning goals.

62. Name three categories of digital devices used for supporting language learners in listening experiences.

Desktops/laptops, tablets, and smartphones.

63. What is the role of networks in supporting language learners' listening experiences?

- *Answer:* Networks connect devices to servers and facilitate the download or streaming of material for listening, making Internet audio and video accessible to users.

64. How has access to native speaker content changed for language teachers and learners in recent years?

Access to native speaker content has significantly increased with the availability of enormous archives of free, authentic material on institutional and commercial media websites, YouTube, and other streaming services.

65. What are the four categories of help options for second language listening, as proposed by Cardenas-Claros and Gruba (2013)?

The four categories are operational, regulatory, compensatory, and explanatory help options.

66. According to Chapelle (2003), how can the computer aid language learners in the context of SLA theory?

The computer can aid learners by making input more comprehensible, directing learners' attention to particular linguistic forms within the input, and serving as a stand-in for a human interlocutor.

67. Name one tool recommended for designing pedagogical material in the provided list.

Blabberize (Animates any image with a moving mouth and audio).

68. What is the role of the computer in providing enhanced input for listening within the theoretical perspective discussed?

The computer's role is to provide enhanced input for listening by increasing salience, modifying input, and offering simplification or elaboration, ultimately supporting learners' attention and autonomy.

69. According to Cardenas-Claros and Gruba (2013), what are some strategies for increasing salience in listening materials?

Strategies for increasing salience include underlining, boldfacing, or coloring targeted language forms in text support (captions or transcripts). Audio material may also be repeated to enhance saliency.

70. Explain the role of multimedia in language learning, as described by Plass and Jones (2005).

Multimedia, combining text and pictures, is proposed to enhance language learning, specifically listening and reading. Plass and Jones suggest principles like the Multimedia Principle, Individual Differences Principle, and Advance Organizer Principle to guide the effective use of multimedia.

71. What is the defining feature of Vandergrift and Goh's (2012) theoretical second language listening model?

The defining feature of Vandergrift and Goh's model is its emphasis on metacognition, particularly the role of metacognitive instruction in making learners more effective and efficient in listening tasks and activities conducted outside of class.

72. What is the main focus of Rost and Wilson's (2013) book on second language listening?

Rost and Wilson's book focuses on the concept of active listening, emphasizing "engaged processing." It explores listening across five frames: affective, top-down, bottom-up, interactive, and autonomous, with a significant emphasis on learner autonomy facilitated by technology.

73. What is a growing trend in language learning, particularly in the context of listening?

The use of mobile devices for language learning, including listening, is a growing trend. Students find benefits in maximizing exposure to language at times and places that suit their lifestyle.

74. How is podcasting beneficial for language learners, as mentioned in the text?

Podcasting is beneficial for language learners as it allows them to record classes, create their episodes, assess pronunciation, listen to short radio shows, offers flexibility in playback, and allows synchronization of episodes.

75. What is content curation in the context of language learning, and why is it significant?

Content curation involves collecting and organizing online materials enriched in terms of topic, language level, and features for language learners. It provides teachers and learners access to relevant and curated materials, offering additional information for informed choices.

76. How can technology be used for interactive listening in language learning?

Technology can be used for digital recording and subsequent analysis by learners of language in face-to-face and online interactions. Applications like Evaer allow audio and video recording of interactions, providing learners with feedback and opportunities for reflection.

77. What is the potential impact of time-shifting technologies on language learning?

Time-shifting technologies, including instant repetition, play speed controls, and automatic pause insertion, have the potential to influence perceptual accuracy and the processing of connected speech. They can enhance processing time and contribute to language learning.

CHAPETR 14

78. What is the fundamental idea from Vygotsky's sociocultural theory that underlies language instruction, including CALL for speaking?

Vygotsky's Zone of Proximal Development (ZPD), which suggests that language is learned in a social setting, emphasizing collaboration and interaction with others.

79. According to Schmidt's Interactionist Hypothesis, what is crucial for L2 learning?

Schmidt's Interactionist Hypothesis emphasizes that learners need to notice the deficiencies or gaps in their L2 capacity, defined by what a native speaker can do, to engage in negotiation of meaning during interaction.

80. What is the key principle of autonomy in CALL for promoting L2 speaking?

Autonomy involves students taking responsibility for their learning process, emphasizing learner empowerment, reflection, and appropriate L2 usage.

81. What are the three constructs of speaking proficiency from a cognitive perspective?

Accuracy (lack of errors), complexity (number of words or clauses), and fluency (relative time measures such as delivery speed and pauses).

82. What is the main focus of Task-Based Instruction (TBI) in language teaching, including CALL?

TBI emphasizes language production and analysis of meaning through real-world activities, collaborations, and problem-solving or information-gap activities.

83. How does Tutorial CALL contribute to L2 speaking practice?

Tutorial CALL allows self-directed speech practice, providing opportunities for learners to engage in speaking activities without conversational partners or classroom instruction.

84. What is the role of Automatic Speech Recognition (ASR) in Tutorial CALL?

ASR systems in Tutorial CALL can provide feedback on pronunciation by comparing students' audio recordings with native speakers, offering a feedback loop for improving pronunciation.

85. How does Computer-Assisted Pronunciation Training (CAPT) contribute to language learning?

CAPT in Tutorial CALL provides a risk-free environment for students to practice pronunciation and intonation, offering more practice time, flexibility, and no penalties for errors.

86. What is the significance of Asynchronous CALL Storytelling in language learning?

Asynchronous CALL Storytelling allows students to become multimedia storytellers, creating narratives with images, text, and audio recordings, providing meaningful speaking practice.

87. What is the focus of Synchronous Computer-Mediated Communication (SCMC) in CALL?

SCMC involves using the computer to mediate communication between people, incorporating synchronous elements like voice or video, providing opportunities for negotiation of meaning and feedback.

CHAPTER 15

88. What is second language acquisition (SLA)?

A: Second Language Acquisition (SLA) is the study of the human capacity to learn languages other than the first, typically occurring during late childhood, adolescence, or adulthood after the acquisition of the first language(s).

89. How does SLA distinguish between second and foreign language acquisition?

SLA makes a distinction between second language acquisition (SLA), where the target language is spoken by the local community, and foreign language acquisition, which occurs in settings where the target language is not spoken locally.

90. What are some broad questions addressed by SLA theories?

SLA theories aim to address questions such as learners' behavior during language acquisition, stages of acquisition, characteristics of developing second language, nature of errors, factors affecting SLA, mechanisms used by learners to understand and produce a second language, fluency development, and variability in attaining a second language.

91. What are the three theoretical frameworks discussed in relation to technology-enhanced SLA research?

The three theoretical frameworks are cognitive approaches, the interaction approach, and sociocultural theory.

92. What characterizes cognitive approaches to SLA?

Cognitive approaches to SLA encompass traditional information processing and emergentism. They focus on understanding the processes that lead to fluent L2 development, including the role of cognitive architecture, working memory, and emergent language development.

93. What is the interaction approach (IA) in SLA?

The Interaction Approach (IA) emphasizes the role of input and interaction in language learning. It suggests that language learners, through interaction, have opportunities to notice differences in their language formulations, receive corrective feedback, and modify their linguistic output, thereby facilitating language development.

94. What is Sociocultural Theory (SCT) in the context of SLA?

Sociocultural Theory (SCT) argues that learning is a social process, and human cognitive activity develops through participation in cultural, linguistic, and historically formed settings. SCT posits that language learning is facilitated by social interaction, involving collaborative dialogue and scaffolding.

95. How is SLA-relevant research in Computer-Assisted Language Learning (CALL) defined?

SLA-relevant CALL research is concerned with employing computer technology for teaching and learning foreign languages. It should be grounded in an identifiable SLA theoretical framework and explore constructs and hypotheses relevant to that framework, explicitly or implicitly investigating the impact of CALL environments on learner processes, interaction, or outcomes.

96. Can you provide examples of SLA-relevant CALL studies from different theoretical frameworks?

Examples include Payne and Whitney's study from a cognitive approach, examining the impact of synchronous chat interaction on L2 oral proficiency; and Smith and Renaud's study from an interactionist approach, using eye-tracking technology to explore the effectiveness of teacher-provided corrective feedback during online conferences.

97. What distinguishes SLA-relevant CALL studies from those that are not SLA-relevant?

SLA-relevant CALL studies are distinguished by clear connections to SLA theoretical frameworks, examining key assumptions relevant to the theory, and explicitly or implicitly investigating the impact of specific CALL environments on learner processes or outcomes. Simply exploring learner attitudes or perceptions toward technology may not be directly relevant to SLA.

98. What types of learner data do CALL researchers collect, and how do they use computer technology to capture and analyze it?

CALL researchers collect SLA-relevant learner data in Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) and Human-Human Interaction (HHI) environments. Computer technology, such as tracking mechanisms, video screen capture, and eye-tracking, is used to capture and analyze learner process data, behaviors, and interactions in various modalities.

99. How do researchers use eye-tracking technology in SLA-relevant CALL studies?

Eye-tracking technology is used to capture learners' eye movements during reading, providing insights into moment-by-moment cognitive processing. Researchers can infer cognitive processes, perceptual saliency, and processing time through eye movement patterns, allowing for a deeper understanding of how learners engage with stimuli in text-based SCMC tasks.

100. Can you provide examples of text mining tools and data visualization tools used in academia?

Examples of text mining tools include Voyant Tools, Wordle, and Google Books NGram Viewer. Data visualization tools include R-Project, Data-Driven Documents (D3js), and Walrus - Graph Visualization Tool.

101. What is the focus of the study conducted within a sociocultural theoretical framework by Suzuki (2013)?

Suzuki (2013) focuses on the benefits of multimodal data collection within a sociocultural theoretical framework. The study explores how capturing multiple modalities of learner interaction provides a fuller picture of task-based language teaching (TBLT) in real teaching contexts, emphasizing the coordination of verbal and non-verbal elements during task-based interaction.

102. What does the study by Smith (2012) using eye-tracking technology reveal about learners' attention to corrective feedback in L2 SCMC?

The study by Smith (2012) reveals that learners attend to about 60% of intensive recasts they receive during L2 SCMC, as measured by eye fixation data. It also indicates that lexical recasts are more easily noticed and retained compared to grammatical recasts, and both stimulated recall and eye-tracking records are favorable predictors of learner noticing and success on post-tests.

103. In terms of linguistic complexity, what does Collentine's (2013) study on SCMC output and input reveal?

Collentine's (2013) study suggests that for linguistic complexity to be evident in learner SCMC output, the input must have certain linguistic features and contain propositional information. The nature and amount of computer-generated input play a crucial role in influencing linguistic complexity in learner output during synchronous computer-mediated communication.

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